

CIARÁN MURPHY

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UNIVERSITY COLLEGE DUBLIN

Placement Director: Nora Strecker nora.strecker@ucd.ie

EDUCATION

University College Dublin PhD in Economics	Dublin, Ireland 2023 –present
Maynooth University MSc in Economics, First Class Honours (1:1)	Kildare, Ireland 2021 –2022
Dublin City University Bachelor of Business Studies, First Class Honours (1:1)	Dublin, Ireland 2017 –2021

RESEARCH FIELDS

Primary: Economics of Education, Labour Economics

Secondary: Applied Microeconomics, Causal Inference, Gender, Inequality

JOB MARKET PAPER

Building Success: The Effect of On-Campus Housing Expansions on Student Outcomes

Housing shortages are increasingly cited as barriers to degree completion. Using a 17-year panel of 1,256 U.S. colleges, I estimate the effect of dormitory expansions on retention and graduation via within-college differencing models, confirmed by stacked difference-in-differences. Large expansions do not affect first-year retention but raise four-year graduation by 1–2.25 percentage points; effects grow with expansion size and cohort exposure and reflect higher total completion rather than re-timing. Mechanism analyses find no rent-market spillovers, pointing to campus housing access as the primary channel. Expanding on-campus capacity is a tractable, institution-controlled policy to raise graduation rates.

PUBLICATIONS

Socioeconomic status and enrolment in science and maths: a machine-learning approach (2026)

with Dáire Crotty, *Education Economics*

WORKING PAPERS

The Origins of the STEM Gender Gap: Evidence from an Analysis of Secondary School Subject Selection (2025)

with Dáire Crotty

Lockdowns and Conspiracy Theories: Evidence from European Policy Variation (2026)

WORK IN PROGRESS

The Other Side of the Game: Coaching Allocation and Player Effort in Football Academies
Draft available soon

OTHER RESEARCH

Exploring the Gender Pay Gap in Early Adulthood: A Longitudinal Analysis Using Growing Up in Ireland Data with Dáire Crotty, commissioned research report for the Department of Children, Disability and Equality

TEACHING

Lecturer at Maynooth University

- Introduction to Quantitative Methods (EC103Q), Behavioural Economics (EC334) Spring 2026
- Introduction to Quantitative Methods (EC103Q), Information Economics (EC230) Spring 2025

Tutor / Teaching Assistant at University College Dublin

- Intermediate Microeconomics II (ECON20180), Economics Research Project (ECON30620) Spring 2026
- Econometrics, MSc (ECON42770) Autumn 2025
- Intermediate Microeconomics II (ECON20180) Spring 2025
- Econometrics, MSc (ECON42770), Exploring Economics (ECON10740) Autumn 2024
- Principles of Microeconomics (ECON10010) Spring 2024
- Introduction to Economics (ECON10770), Intermediate Microeconomics I (ECON20010) Autumn 2023

University Tutor at Maynooth University (2022–2023)

- Full-time Departmental Tutor and Head of Economics Support Centre. Coordinated and delivered tutorials, provided one-to-one tuition to undergraduate and postgraduate students, and acted as Departmental Advisor to the Access Office.

SCHOLARSHIPS AND AWARDS

- PhD Research Fund, University College Dublin 2025
- School of Economics Scholarship, University College Dublin 2023
- Paddy Geary Prize for First Class Honours and First in Class in MSc Economics, Maynooth University 2023
- Entrance Scholarship for Academic Excellence, Maynooth University 2022
- Entrance Scholarship for Academic Excellence, Dublin City University 2017

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

- Research & Reading Group Organiser, School of Economics, University College Dublin 2024 –present
- Postgraduate Researcher, Geary Institute for Public Policy 2023 –present
- Research Micro Files Researcher (Officer of Statistics), Central Statistics Office 2022–2023, 2025

PRESENTATIONS

- **2026:** Growing Up in Ireland Annual Conference, Dublin (scheduled); EDGE Jamboree, Munich (scheduled); Irish Economic Association Conference, Tipperary; Research & Reading Group, UCD; Leuven Economics of Education Research Conference, Leuven; CESifo/ifo Junior Workshop on Economics of Education, Munich; Young Irish Economists Seminar Series, Dublin; UCD School of Economics PhD Seminar, Dublin; Lisbon Economics and Statistics of Education Conference, Lisbon; Irish Postgraduate & Early Career Economists Conference, Maynooth
- **2025:** Workshop on the Economics of Education, Leuven; Research & Reading Group, UCD; UCD School of Economics PhD Seminar, Dublin

OTHER

- **Software:** R, Stata, Gretl, L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office (Word, PowerPoint, Excel)
- **Languages:** English (fluent), Irish (advanced), Spanish (beginner)

References

Paul Devereux (Advisor), University College Dublin, devereux@ucd.ie